

CAREER PATHS

A qualified product designer needs to build a portfolio of successful work to get established. There are many fields in which you can specialize, but you may need a graduate degree for some of the more technical fields, such as biomedical engineering.

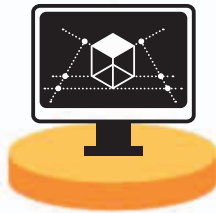
INTERN While getting a degree, you can gain work experience as a product design intern with an engineering company or design consultancy to build your portfolio.

GRADUATE With a bachelor's degree, you may join a professional design association to gain practical training.



PRODUCT DESIGNER

The work requires you to consult with clients, research the needs of users, and then sketch ideas and develop them into plans using specialized software.



VEHICLE DESIGNER

Works in the transportation industry, creating new concepts for car bodies, lighter seats for aircraft, or clearer instrument panels for trains.



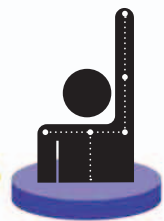
HEALTH CARE ENGINEER

Applies engineering and design principles in the field of health care to create medical products, such as prosthetics and robotic surgical instruments.



CONSUMER PRODUCT DESIGNER

Specializes in developing better consumer products, such as glassware, vacuum cleaners, computers, and handheld electronics.



ERGONOMIST

Focuses on the functionality of the products people use at home and in office spaces. They design new products, such as desks, kitchen equipment, or industrial tools, and try to make them safe, comfortable, and easy to operate.

SKILLS GUIDE



A high level of creativity in devising fresh ideas and new product features that will appeal to buyers.



Self-discipline to plan and organize all stages of a project to ensure delivery on time and to budget.



Excellent numerical skills for calculating the dimensions and proportions of a product.



The ability to explain complex ideas to clients clearly, both verbally and in writing.



Good computer skills for working on specialized Computer-aided Design (CAD) programs.



Close attention to detail when working to technical specifications or client briefs.